



PENTATONIC EXERCISES FOR MASTERY

Here's a comprehensive list of pentatonic exercises designed to develop your technique, fretboard knowledge, and musicality. These exercises will help you navigate the pentatonic scale confidently and creatively.

1. BASIC PENTATONIC PATTERNS

- Play the **Minor Pentatonic Scale** (e.g., E Minor Pentatonic) in all **five CAGED positions**.
- Play the **Major Pentatonic Scale** (e.g., G Major Pentatonic) in all **five CAGED positions**.
- Practise ascending and descending each position, focusing on clean notes.

2. CONNECT THE PATTERNS

- Link adjacent positions across the fretboard.
Example: Move from Position 1 to Position 2 seamlessly.
- Practise sliding between positions on the same string for smooth transitions.

3. SEQUENCES IN PENTATONIC

- **3-Note Sequences:** Play three notes up, then one note back.
Example: E-G-A, G-A-B, A-B-D, etc.
- **4-Note Sequences:** Play four notes up, then start the sequence on the next note.
Example: E-G-A-B, G-A-B-D, etc.
- **5-Note Sequences:** Play five notes up, then start the sequence on the next note.
Example: E-G-A-B-D, G-A-B-D-E, etc.
- **6-Note Sequences:** Play six notes up (across 3 strings), then start the sequence on the 2nd string
- **Skipping Notes:** Skip one note in the scale, then return.
Example: E-A, G-B, A-D, etc.

4. STRING SKIPPING

- Play the pentatonic scale, skipping one string at a time (e.g., play on the 6th string, then the 4th string, etc.).
- Combine string skipping with sequences for added complexity.



5. 3 NOTE PER STRING PENTATONICS

- Connect 2 patterns together by playing as 3 note per string (NB: you will hit the same on two strings) E-G-A, A-B-D, D-E-G, G-A-B etc.
- Combine tapping across the two patterns , especially if the stretches are too much for your fretting hand alone.

8. PLAY IN DIFFERENT KEYS

- Practise the pentatonic scale in multiple keys.
 - Use the **circle of fifths** to choose keys systematically.
 - Shift the same patterns to new root positions.

10. IMPROVISATION WITH PENTATONICS

- Jam over a backing track using only the pentatonic scale.
- Limit yourself to a single position for the first few minutes, then expand.
- Focus on phrasing and expression rather than speed.

14. ADD SLIDES, HAMMER-ONS, AND PULL-OFFS

- Use hammer-ons and pull-offs between each note.
- Incorporate slides to connect notes seamlessly.

15. PENTATONICS WITH CHROMATIC PASSING NOTES

- Add chromatic passing notes between scale tones for a jazzier feel.
Example: In A Minor Pentatonic, add notes like A-A#-C or D-D#-E.

17. EXPLORE MINOR AND MAJOR PENTATONIC SWITCHING



- Alternate between minor and major pentatonic scales over the same root note.
Example: Use A Minor Pentatonic and A Major Pentatonic interchangeably.

18. EXPLORE PENTATONICS WITH MODES

- Use the pentatonic scale as a base to explore modes.
Example: Overlay A Minor Pentatonic on A Dorian (A–B–C–D–E–F#–G).

20. CREATE LICKS USING PENTATONICS

- Create licks using the pentatonic scale.
- Apply techniques like bends, slides, hammer-ons, and pull-offs to make them expressive.

21. RECORD YOURSELF

- Record your practice sessions and improvisations to track your progress and identify areas for improvement.

Mastering these exercises will give you confidence in using the pentatonic scale for solos, improvisation, and creative exploration. Which one will you start with? Let me know how it goes! 🎸👾